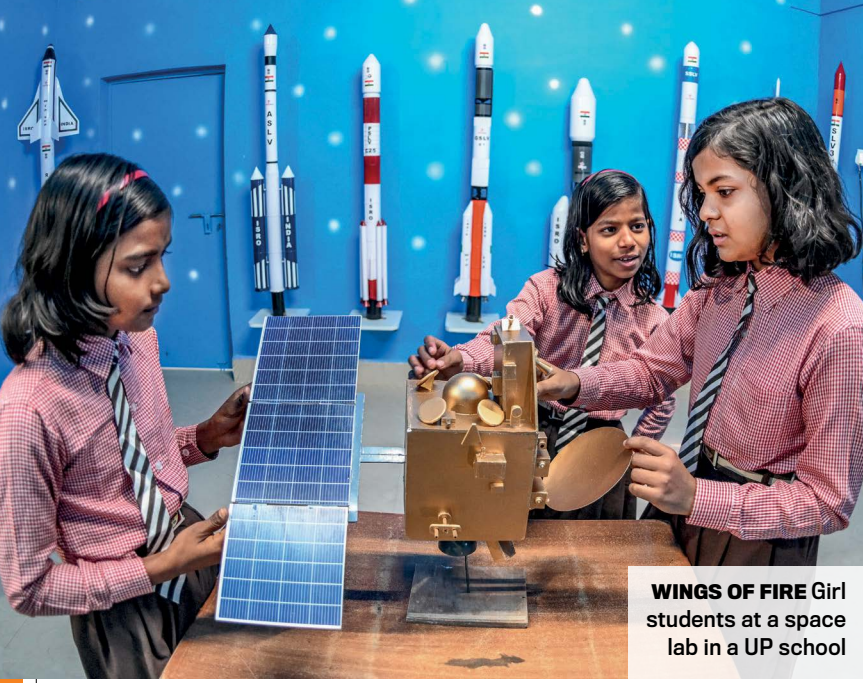


WINGS OF FIRE Girl students at a space lab in a UP school

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

GROSS DOMESTIC BEHAVIOUR

GENDER ATTITUDES

CRACKS IN EQUALITY

While Indian society embraces gender equality in education and employment, entrenched patriarchy continues to shape household decisions and personal freedoms for women

How do Indians perceive gender roles in their households and society? The India Today Gross Domestic Behaviour (GDB) survey sought to answer this by posing six thoughtfully designed questions to over 9,000 respondents nationwide. The results on 'Gender Attitudes' paint a picture of a country caught between progress and persistent patriarchy. Kerala emerges as a beacon of gender parity, topping the rankings, while Uttar Pradesh languishes at the bottom.

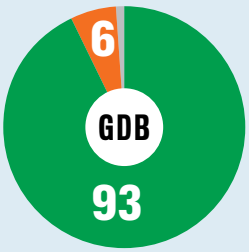
In a society where tradition often dictates gender norms, a staggering 69 per cent of the respondents believe that men should have the final say in household decisions. This sentiment is most pronounced in Uttar Pradesh, where an overwhelming 96 per cent endorse this view. In contrast, Kerala offers a progressive counterpoint, with three-quarters of its respondents rejecting this notion outright.

These attitudes extend to financial independence for women. While 91 per cent of Kerala's respondents—once again the highest among all states—support a woman's right to manage her own earnings, Odisha lags with just 27 per cent backing this idea.

Attitudes toward domestic violence expose another troubling reality. While 83 per cent of the respondents disapprove of a husband beating his wife, the stark reality is that 14 per cent of women themselves justify such violence. The variation across states is telling—only 2 per cent of Uttarakhand's respondents condone domestic violence, while in Andhra Pradesh, the figure climbs to 31 per cent.

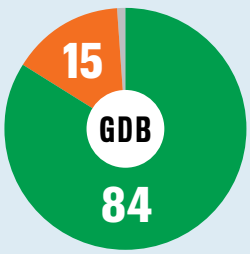
Education and employment rights for women attract widespread approval, with

Q. Should daughters in the family be encouraged to study or pursue education as much as sons?



***98%** in **ODISHA** believe daughters have the same right to education as sons; **22%** in **GUJARAT** don't agree with this notion*

Q. Should female members of the family be encouraged to take up a job outside the home?



***98%** in **UTTAR PRADESH** are willing to encourage their daughters to take up jobs outside the home; **38%** in **GUJARAT** are opposed to this idea*

Yes No Did not answer

(Figures in percentage)

The 'Yes' and 'No' responses in GDB (Gross Domestic Behaviour) have been calculated as the combined percentages of answers–'Yes' (strongly agree and somewhat agree) and 'No' (disagree and somewhat disagree)